Ali Demir

Economist | Applied Microeconomics

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Migration, Labor and Demographic Economics.
Secondary: Housing and Regional Economics.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics *2023–2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Germany

- Dissertation: *Essays in Empirical Family and Regional Economics. (Magna Cum Laude)*
- Advisors: Thomas K. Bauer and Arnaud Chevalier.

MSc in Behavioral and Applied Economics *2021–2023*
University of Trento, Italy

- Exchange Year (Erasmus+) in Public Economics, Freie Universität Berlin, Germany.
- Research Visit, Host: Susann Fiedler at Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria.

BSc in Mathematics *2016–2021*
Middle East Technical University, Ankara, Turkey

JOB MARKET PAPER

German Internal Migration: A Marriage Market Perspective. Asks whether young, female-skewed East–West migration after German reunification affected divorce rates in receiving West German districts. Assembles a new harmonized district-level panel of divorce, migration, and population statistics for 320 West German districts (1985–2007), digitized in part from printed state statistical publications. Instruments cumulative migration exposure with a shift-share design that interacts districts' 1961 population shares of earlier migrants from East Germany with a female-weighted East German labor-market shock. Preferred IV estimates imply a stabilizing relationship: a one-standard-deviation increase in predicted exposure is associated with about 0.26 fewer annual divorces per 1,000 residents, roughly 10% of the sample mean, consistent with partner-availability adjustment in receiving marriage markets.

WORKING PAPERS

Housing Security and Family Expansion: Evidence from German Homeownership. Estimates the effect of homeownership on fertility among West German women, using SOEP-Core panel data with district and year fixed effects and parental homeownership as an instrument. Homeownership significantly accelerates the transition from first to second birth. The estimate for the cumulative number of children is small and statistically indistinguishable from zero, consistent with a tempo effect on the timing of second births; effects on completed family size remain open. Estimates are local to women whose ownership depends on their parents' ownership, and inference is robust to weak instruments.

Transition to Adulthood: Local Rents and Leaving the Parental Home. Links SOEP-Core residence histories to RWI-GEO-REDX quality-adjusted rent indices at the parental-home postal code to study young adults' first exit from the parental home, with heterogeneity by migration background. Across locations, higher rents predict earlier exit, consistent with high-rent areas being opportunity-rich. Within postal codes over time, the rent gradient turns weakly negative and imprecise; bounds rule out large affordability effects, and lead–lag placebo tests attribute part of the remaining gradient to local trends rather than rents.

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate (Wissenschaftlicher Mitarbeiter) *Oct 2023–Sep 2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- DFG Research Training Group 2484, "Regional Disparities and Economic Policy."
- Course administration for Econometric Evaluation of Economic Policies.

Research Intern *Jul 2022–Oct 2022*
Vienna University of Economics and Business, Institute for Cognition and Behavior

- Designed and implemented an oTree bargaining experiment on overconfidence, prosociality and motivated beliefs. Its data form the basis of the MSc thesis.

Student Research Assistant to Constantinos Hadjichristidis *Jan 2022–Aug 2022*
University of Trento, Department of Economics and Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor / Course Designer: Introductory Migration Economics *Winter Semester 2025/26*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Designed an English-language bachelor-level seminar with lecture material on migration definitions, migrant selection, Roy model intuition, integration and human capital, Chiswick–Borjas earnings assimilation, empirical designs and labor-market effects.

Thesis Supervision *2023-2026*
Ruhr University Bochum, Chair of Empirical Economics

- Co-supervised BSc and MSc theses.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

European Network for Housing Research (ENHR) Annual Conference July 2025

RTG 2484 Internal Retreats 2024-2026

SKILLS

Data	SOEP-Core; RWI-GEO-REDX; FDZ secure-enclave workflows; BBSR/INKAR; OCR-assisted digitization of historical regional statistics.
Software	Stata, R, Python, LaTeX, oTree.
Languages	Turkish (Native), English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Italian (Elementary).

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Assistant Editor *Jan 2022–Oct 2023*
behavioraleconomics.com, remote (UK)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

University of Trento Merit Scholarship, 2021–2023.
Erasmus+ Mobility Grant, 2022–2023.
METU Alumni Association Merit Scholarship, 2016–2019.
Honor Roll, Middle East Technical University, 2016–2017.

REFERENCES

Thomas K. Bauer
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